

DIGITAL SKILLS DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME

A Partnership Proposal for Batho Pele Community Centre

Presented by Pace Academy, Powered by Pace Tech

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Overview

Pace Academy, a product of Pace Tech, proposes a structured digital skills development programme to be delivered at and through the Batho Pele Community Centre in Johannesburg. The programme will give youth in the community access to practical digital skills and formally accredited NQF qualifications at prices that are genuinely affordable.

South Africa's youth unemployment rate stands at 46% in 2026. The majority of unemployed young people are not unemployable. They are uncertified and digitally underequipped. This programme addresses that directly.

Pace Academy is not a pilot project or a concept. The platform is fully built and operational. Learners can enroll and start their first course today. This proposal outlines how Batho Pele and Pace Tech can formalise a partnership to deploy it for the benefit of the local community.

Key Detail	Information
Proposing organisation	Pace Tech (trading as Pace Academy)
Target beneficiaries	Youth aged 16 to 35 in the Batho Pele community and surrounding areas
Delivery modes	On-site at Batho Pele Community Centre and online via Pace Academy platform
Pricing for learners	Non-accredited courses from R250. Accredited courses from R2,500 based on qualification level (market rate: up to R40,000)

The Challenge Facing Our Youth

Young people in Johannesburg and across South Africa face a specific and solvable problem. The talent exists. The motivation exists. What is missing is affordable access to the skills and credentials that employers require.

Challenge	Detail
Youth unemployment	46% of young South Africans are unemployed as of 2026. The majority are capable but lack recognised qualifications.
Cost of accredited courses	A single accredited short course costs R5,000 to R40,000 at traditional skills development companies. Most township youth cannot afford this.
Free platforms are not recognised	YouTube and free online content provide learning but no certification. Employers in the formal sector require recognised qualifications.
No local digital platform exists	There is no African-built learning platform that combines affordability, accreditation, and digital skills in one place. Until Pace Academy.

This is not a talent problem. It is an access problem. And it is solvable.

A Digital Skills Programme at Batho Pele

Pace Academy proposes a structured, ongoing digital skills development programme delivered through two complementary modes:

On-Site Delivery

- Instructor-led sessions held weekly at the Batho Pele Community Centre
- Registered learners attend scheduled classes using available on-site devices
- Hands-on coding and digital skills practice using the Pace Academy platform
- Community environment fosters peer learning and accountability
- On-site coordinator manages attendance and learner support

Online Delivery

- Full access to the Pace Academy platform from any internet-connected device
- Learners continue studying between on-site sessions at their own pace
- In-browser code editor means no software installation is required
- All progress is tracked automatically for educators and coordinators to monitor
- Certificates are issued automatically when a course is completed

What Learners Will Study

The programme offers two tiers of courses, designed to meet learners where they are and take them as far as they want to go.

Tier 1: Non-Accredited Skills Courses

Affordable, practical, and immediately useful. No prerequisites. Any learner can start today. Courses start from R250.

Course	Description
Web Development	HTML, CSS, JavaScript and building real websites from scratch
App Development	Introduction to mobile and web app development for beginners
Digital Marketing 101	Social media, content creation, and online presence for small businesses
Excel and Data Basics	Practical office skills every South African employer expects

Tier 2: Accredited Courses

Formally recognised by SETA and QCTO. The same qualifications available at traditional skills development companies, at a fraction of the cost. Courses start from R2,500 based on qualification level.

Qualification	Description	Market Rate
Systems Support	Formal qualification recognised by SETA and South African employers in the IT sector	Up to R40,000
End User Computing	Foundation digital literacy qualification widely accepted across industries	Up to R15,000
Business Administration	Formal qualification for office and administrative roles in the South African job market	Up to R20,000

Same accreditation. Same employer recognition. Accessible to our community.

How This Partnership Works

Pace Academy Provides:

- Full access to the Pace Academy learning platform for enrolled learners
- All non-accredited digital skills courses for enrolled learners
- Accredited courses for learners who wish to obtain formal qualifications
- Educator and coordinator dashboard with full learner progress tracking
- Automatic certificate generation on course completion
- Technical support and ongoing platform maintenance
- On-site setup assistance and onboarding support for the first cohort
- A dedicated point of contact at Pace Tech for the duration of the partnership

Batho Pele Community Centre Provides:

- A dedicated physical space for on-site training sessions
- Community outreach and learner recruitment support
- A community coordinator to manage attendance and learner queries
- Access to available devices or a computer lab for on-site sessions
- Internet connectivity for on-site sessions where possible
- Community endorsement and trust, which is critical for learner uptake
- Regular feedback from learners to help Pace Tech improve the programme

How This Programme Generates Sustainable Income

The Pace Academy programme at Batho Pele is designed to be financially sustainable from the start. Below are three clear income streams with conservative projections based on realistic learner numbers.

Stream 1: Non-Accredited Course Subscriptions

Scenario	Learners	Monthly Fee	Monthly Revenue	Annual Revenue
Initial cohort	50	R250	R12,500	R150,000
Growth (Month 6)	100	R250	R25,000	R300,000
Growth (Month 12)	200	R250	R50,000	R600,000

50 learners at R250 a month brings in R12,500 every month. As the programme grows and more learners enroll through community outreach, that number scales directly. No additional infrastructure cost is required to add more learners.

Stream 2: Accredited Course Enrollment

Course	Learners	Course Fee	Duration	Revenue
Fullstack Development	25	R8,000	6 months	R200,000
Systems Support	25	R5,000	6 months	R125,000
End User Computing	30	R2,500	3 months	R75,000
Combined (Year 1 est.)	80	Various	Ongoing	R400,000

25 learners on a Fullstack Development course at R8,000 each generates R200,000 per cohort. These courses run twice a year, meaning each accredited programme can generate R400,000 annually from that course alone.

Stream 3: Corporate Partnership and Learnership Sponsorship

This is the highest-value stream and the most scalable.

The model works as follows:

- Pace Academy approaches tech companies and corporates seeking junior developer talent
- A company typically spends R25,000 or more to hire and onboard a junior developer
- Pace Academy offers them a sponsored learnership partnership at R12,500 per learner per month
- The company gets a pipeline of trained, work-ready talent at half the cost of a hire
- The learner spends the first 6 months training on Pace Academy, fully accredited

- The second 6 months, the learner goes to the company for workplace experience
- At the end of 12 months, the learner holds a formal qualification and real work experience
- The company has a proven candidate they can hire permanently at no additional recruitment cost

Scenario	Partners	Learners Sponsored	Monthly per Learner	Monthly Revenue	Annual Revenue
1 corporate partner	1	5	R12,500	R62,500	R750,000
3 corporate partners	3	15	R12,500	R187,500	R2,250,000
5 corporate partners	5	25	R12,500	R312,500	R3,750,000

One corporate partner sponsoring 5 learners generates R750,000 per year. The company saves on recruitment. The learner gets a qualification and workplace experience. Pace Academy generates sustainable, recurring income. This is a genuine win for all three parties.

Combined Year 1 Revenue Projection

Revenue Stream	Conservative Estimate	Notes
Non-accredited subscriptions	R150,000	50 learners at R250/month for 12 months
Accredited course enrollment	R400,000	80 learners across multiple courses
Corporate partnerships (1 partner)	R750,000	5 sponsored learners at R12,500/month
Total Year 1 (conservative)	R1,300,000	Based on one partner and modest learner numbers

These are conservative figures. As the programme grows, the number of corporate partners increases, and word spreads through the community, all three streams compound. The infrastructure is already built. Every rand of revenue above operating costs goes directly back into expanding access.

Let Us Build This Together

The youth of this community have the talent. They have the motivation. What they need is a platform that gives them the tools, the credentials, and the pathway to employment at a price that does not close the door before it opens.

Pace Academy is that platform. Batho Pele Community Centre is the ideal partner to bring it to the people who need it most. Together, we can give young people in Johannesburg a genuine path from where they are today to a recognised digital qualification and a job.

The platform is built. The courses are ready. We just need to open the doors together.

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Course Curriculum Overview

The following four courses form the core curriculum of the Pace Academy programme at Batho Pele Community Centre. Two are non-accredited skills courses designed for immediate, affordable entry. Two are QCTO-accredited qualifications that lead to nationally recognised certificates.

Code	Course	Type	Duration	Target Learner
PA-NA-01	Fullstack Web Development	Non-Accredited	12 weeks	Beginner. No experience needed.
PA-NA-02	Office Administration and Computing	Non-Accredited	8 weeks	Anyone seeking office and admin skills.
PA-AC-01	Software Development (NQF5)	QCTO Accredited	6 months	Learner with basic coding foundation.
PA-AC-02	Systems Support (NQF5)	QCTO Accredited	6 months	Learner interested in IT support and infrastructure.

Course Overview

This course takes a complete beginner from zero to a working fullstack web developer. Learners build real projects every week using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and Python. By the end of 12 weeks, every learner has a portfolio of three live websites they built themselves. No prior experience required. Delivered online via Pace Academy and reinforced through on-site sessions at Batho Pele.

Week	Module	Topics Covered	Assessment
Week 1	Introduction to the Web	How the internet works. Browsers, servers, URLs, HTTP. Setting up your dev environment on Pace Academy.	Quiz: Web basics
Week 2	HTML Foundations	HTML document structure, tags, headings, paragraphs, links, images, forms, tables.	Project: Build your personal profile page
Week 3	CSS Styling	Selectors, colours, fonts, box model, margins, padding, borders, basic layouts.	Project: Style your profile page
Week 4	CSS Layouts and Responsive Design	Flexbox, CSS Grid, media queries, mobile-first design principles.	Project: Build a responsive landing page
Week 5	JavaScript Fundamentals	Variables, data types, functions, conditionals, loops, DOM manipulation.	Quiz and coding exercises
Week 6	JavaScript Intermediate	Events, arrays, objects, fetch API, working with JSON data from an API.	Project: Build an interactive quiz app
Week 7	Introduction to Python	Python syntax, variables, functions, conditionals, loops, lists, dictionaries.	Coding exercises on Pace Academy code editor
Week 8	Python for the Web	Flask framework basics, routes, templates, handling form data, returning JSON.	Project: Build a simple Flask web app
Week 9	Databases and SQL	What is a database. SQLite basics. CREATE, INSERT, SELECT, UPDATE, DELETE.	Project: Add a database to your Flask app
Week 10	Connecting Frontend to Backend	Fetch API on the frontend calling Python Flask routes. Full request-response cycle.	Project: Build a fullstack contact form app
Week 11	Capstone Project Build	Learner builds a complete fullstack project of their choice: frontend, backend, database.	Capstone project week 1
Week 12	Capstone Completion and Presentation	Finalise, deploy and present capstone project. Portfolio review. Certificate issued.	Final project submission and presentation

Outcome: Learner receives a Pace Academy Certificate of Completion and a portfolio of 3 live projects. Ready for junior developer roles or to proceed to PA-AC-01.

Course Overview

A practical, job-ready course covering the digital tools used in every South African office environment. Learners gain hands-on skills in Microsoft Office, email communication, data entry, file management, and basic business administration. Designed for learners seeking admin, receptionist, clerical, or office support roles. No experience required.

Week	Module	Topics Covered	Assessment
Week 1	Computer Basics and Digital Literacy	Using a computer. File management. Keyboard shortcuts. Internet and email basics. Google Workspace overview.	Practical test: Navigate and organise a file system
Week 2	Microsoft Word	Creating and formatting documents. Headers, footers, tables, bullet points, page layout, spell check, mail merge basics.	Project: Format a professional business letter
Week 3	Microsoft Excel Basics	Spreadsheet navigation. Entering and formatting data. Basic formulas: SUM, AVERAGE, COUNT, MIN, MAX.	Project: Build a monthly budget tracker
Week 4	Microsoft Excel Intermediate	IF statements, VLOOKUP, charts and graphs, conditional formatting, data sorting and filtering.	Project: Build a staff attendance register
Week 5	Microsoft PowerPoint	Creating presentations. Slide layouts, themes, inserting images, charts and transitions. Presenting professionally.	Project: Build a 10-slide company presentation
Week 6	Professional Email and Communication	Email etiquette. Writing professional emails. Calendar management. Scheduling meetings. Outlook and Gmail.	Project: Draft a formal email sequence for a workplace scenario
Week 7	Office Administration Fundamentals	Filing systems. Basic bookkeeping concepts. Petty cash. Purchase orders. Office supplies management. Reception duties.	Quiz: Office administration procedures
Week 8	Capstone and Portfolio	Learner completes a simulated office admin task: draft documents, spreadsheets, presentation, and email correspondence.	Final portfolio submission. Certificate issued.

Outcome: Learner receives a Pace Academy Certificate of Completion. Ready for admin, clerical, and office support roles in any South African industry.

Course Overview

A formally accredited QCTO qualification at NQF Level 5. This course prepares learners to design, develop, test, and maintain software applications. Covers frontend and backend development, version control, databases, and software engineering principles. Upon completion, learners receive a nationally recognised NQF Level 5 certificate accepted by employers across South Africa. Prerequisite: basic computer literacy or completion of PA-NA-01.

Phase 1: Foundations (Weeks 1 to 8)

Week	Module	Topics Covered	Assessment
Week 1–2	Programming Fundamentals	Computational thinking. Problem solving. Introduction to Python. Variables, data types, operators, I/O.	Written assessment and coding quiz
Week 3–4	Control Structures and Functions	Conditionals, loops, functions, scope, recursion, error handling, debugging techniques.	Practical coding assignment
Week 5–6	Object-Oriented Programming	Classes, objects, inheritance, encapsulation, polymorphism. OOP design principles.	OOP design and implementation project
Week 7–8	Data Structures and Algorithms	Lists, stacks, queues, dictionaries, trees. Sorting and searching algorithms. Big O basics.	Algorithm challenge assessment

Phase 2: Web Development and Databases (Weeks 9 to 16)

Week	Module	Topics Covered	Assessment
Week 9–10	Web Development Fundamentals	HTML5, CSS3, responsive design, accessibility. JavaScript fundamentals and DOM manipulation.	Build a responsive static website
Week 11–12	Backend Web Development	Flask or Django framework. Routes, templates, REST API design, JSON, HTTP methods.	Build and test a REST API
Week 13–14	Databases and SQL	Relational databases. SQLite and PostgreSQL. CRUD operations. Database design and normalisation.	Design and build a database schema
Week 15–16	Fullstack Integration and Version Control	Git and GitHub. Connecting frontend to backend. Deployment basics. Collaborative coding workflows.	Fullstack mini-project with Git history

Phase 3: Professional Practice and Capstone (Weeks 17 to 24)

Week	Module	Topics Covered	Assessment
Week 17–18	Software Engineering Principles	SDLC models. Agile and Scrum basics. Testing: unit, integration, user acceptance. Code review.	Participate in a mock sprint
Week 19–20	Security and Ethics in Software	Basic cybersecurity principles. OWASP top 10. Data privacy. POPIA Act. Ethical software development.	Security audit of a given codebase
Week 21–22	Capstone Project Development	Learner designs and builds a fullstack application addressing a real community or business problem.	Progress review and mentor check-in
Week 23–24	Capstone Presentation and QCTO Assessment	Final project submission. External QCTO assessment and moderation. Learner portfolio review.	QCTO summative assessment. NQF5 certificate issued.

Outcome: QCTO-accredited NQF Level 5 Certificate in Software Development. Nationally recognised. Accepted by South African employers across all sectors. Qualifies learner for junior developer, software tester, and entry-level engineer roles.

Course Overview

A formally accredited QCTO qualification at NQF Level 5 in Systems Support. This course prepares learners to install, configure, maintain, and support computer hardware, software, networks, and end-user systems. Covers technical support, networking fundamentals, operating systems, and IT service management. Upon completion, learners receive a nationally recognised NQF Level 5 certificate accepted by employers across South Africa. Prerequisite: basic computer literacy or completion of PA-NA-02.

Phase 1: Hardware and Operating Systems (Weeks 1 to 8)

Week	Module	Topics Covered	Assessment
Week 1–2	Computer Hardware Fundamentals	PC components: CPU, RAM, storage, motherboard, PSU, GPU. Identifying, installing and replacing components. Safety procedures.	Hardware identification practical test
Week 3–4	Operating Systems: Windows	Windows installation and configuration. User accounts, permissions, group policy basics. File system management. Troubleshooting common issues.	Windows configuration practical assignment
Week 5–6	Operating Systems: Linux	Linux fundamentals. Terminal commands, file system, user management, permissions, shell scripting basics.	Linux command-line practical test
Week 7–8	Software Installation and Management	Installing, updating and uninstalling software. Licensing. Antivirus and endpoint security. System backups and recovery.	Software management scenario assessment

Phase 2: Networking and Infrastructure (Weeks 9 to 16)

Week	Module	Topics Covered	Assessment
Week 9–10	Networking Fundamentals	OSI model. IP addressing, subnetting. TCP/IP. DNS, DHCP, HTTP, FTP. LAN and WAN concepts.	Networking quiz and IP addressing exercise
Week 11–12	Network Setup and Configuration	Setting up a small office network. Routers, switches, Wi-Fi configuration. Cable types and connectors. Network troubleshooting.	Network setup practical project
Week 13–14	Network Security Basics	Firewalls, VPNs, access control. Common threats: phishing, malware, ransomware. Incident response basics.	Security scenario assessment

Week	Module	Topics Covered	Assessment
Week 15–16	Cloud and Remote Support	Introduction to cloud services: AWS, Azure, Google Cloud basics. Remote desktop tools. Supporting users remotely.	Cloud and remote support practical

Phase 3: IT Service Management and Capstone (Weeks 17 to 24)

Week	Module	Topics Covered	Assessment
Week 17–18	IT Service Management and ITIL	ITIL framework basics. Service desk operations. Ticketing systems. SLAs. Incident, problem and change management.	ITIL scenario-based assessment
Week 19–20	End User Support and Communication	Supporting users professionally. Documentation. Creating knowledge base articles. Communication skills in a technical environment.	Role-play: handle a simulated support ticket queue
Week 21–22	Virtualisation and Emerging Technologies	VMware and VirtualBox basics. Virtual machines. Introduction to IoT, AI tools in IT support, and automation.	Virtual machine setup practical
Week 23–24	Capstone and QCTO Assessment	Learner completes a full systems support scenario: diagnose, fix and document a simulated IT infrastructure problem.	QCTO summative assessment. NQF5 certificate issued.

Outcome: QCTO-accredited NQF Level 5 Certificate in Systems Support. Nationally recognised. Qualifies learner for IT support technician, help desk analyst, junior systems administrator, and network support roles across South Africa.